

Gatekeeper Objections: Practice List

For: Mark and G-Anne | **Campaign:** RIA Outreach (Playbook v2)

Rule for every call: never hang up with nothing. Leave with a **transfer**, a **callback time**, a **direct line**, or an **email**.

Your mindset: the gatekeeper is like a building guard. Their job is not to stop everyone. It's to let in people with a clear reason. Be polite, short and confident. You're asking for two minutes with the owner.

Before you dial (Playbook Section 3): check GHL and the lead source. Know if you're calling a **firm owner** or an **individual advisor**, and the person's first name.

Never say to a gatekeeper (Playbook Section 1): anything about selling, buying, merging or recruiting, any numbers, or who else we're talking to. Every owner conversation is confidential.

How to read this: each row has the situation, your goal, and **why it works**, explained with an everyday example.

A. Screening questions

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
1	"What's this regarding?"	Give a one-sentence reason, then ask for the owner again.	Like telling a guard "I'm here to see Mr. Reyes." You don't show them your whole presentation. Short answers sound like you belong. Long ones sound like a sales pitch.
2	"Is this a sales call?"	Answer honestly, then give the real reason.	Like a guard asking "Delivery?" If you only say "No," they get suspicious. If you say "No, I'm here for a business meeting," they relax. A clear reason replaces doubt.
3	"What company are you with? What do you do?"	Say who One Wealth Map is in one line (playbook line).	Like a calling card. One line tells them who you are. Nobody reads a brochure at the front desk.
4	"Does the owner know you? Are they expecting your call?"	Be honest and stay confident.	Like a new neighbor knocking on a door. You don't pretend to be a relative. You say who you are, kindly. If you lie and get caught, the door closes for good.
5	"How did you get this number?"	Give the real source. Confirm the wording with Sam.	Like a customer asking a shop how it got their address. A clear, honest answer calms them. Dodging makes it feel shady.
6	"Can I tell them what it's about?"	Share enough to be passed along. Save the details.	Like sealing a letter. The secretary delivers it but doesn't read it. "Confidential business matter" tells them it's important and private.

B. Owner not available

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
7	"They're with a client."	Get a specific callback time and log it in GHL.	Like a doctor in surgery. You don't just leave. You ask the nurse, "What time will the doctor be out?" "Later" is not a time, and without one you start from zero.
8	"They're out of the office this week."	Find out the day they're back.	Like a store closed for the holidays. You check the sign for the reopening date so you come back on the right day, not by guessing.
9	"They're in meetings all day, every day."	Find a gap in their day.	Like catching a busy professor. You don't knock during class. You come before the first class or after the last one. Owners are often free early or late.
10	"They don't take calls. Everything goes through me."	Make the gatekeeper your partner.	Like a barangay hall. You follow their process, and the secretary helps you. Fight the process, and nothing moves.

C. Brush-offs

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
11	"Send an email."	Say yes, then ask for the owner's direct email or a time.	Like "just leave it at the front desk." Your letter may sit in a pile. Asking to address it directly gives it a real chance to be read.
12	"Send it to info@ and we'll pass it along."	Avoid the general inbox.	Like dropping a letter in a box marked "General." It might take weeks, or never get read. A direct address is like handing it to the person.
13	"Leave a message and they'll call you back."	Leave a short message and set your own follow-up.	Like ordering food and waiting forever. If you don't follow up, it may never come. Owning the next step keeps you in control.
14	"Just leave a voicemail."	Use the playbook voicemail. Keep it under 20 seconds.	Like a text message vs. a long letter. People finish short messages. Say your number slowly, twice, like reading a phone number to a friend.
15	"We get calls like this all the time."	Show respect and keep the ask small.	Like asking a busy cashier for one quick thing. "Just two minutes" is easy to say yes to. A long request is easy to say no to.

D. The gatekeeper decides

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
16	"They're not interested." (said for the owner)	Let the owner decide. Ask to send one short note.	Like a house helper saying "Ma'am doesn't want it." Ma'am never actually saw it. A short note lets the right person decide, without arguing with the helper.
17	"I handle these decisions."	Find out kindly if they're an owner or staff.	Like the secretary of a barangay captain. They can schedule visits, but only the captain can sign. Respect the secretary, but some matters need the boss.
18	"We already have an advisor." / "We don't need services."	Clear up the confusion.	Like a tutor being turned away because "the kids already have a teacher." You're not there for the kids. You want to talk to the school owner. Explain it's for the owner, from our founder.
19	"We're not hiring." / "They're not looking for a job."	Stay calm. Don't explain the offer. Ask for the right person.	Like an envelope marked "personal." You don't open it at the reception desk. The details are for the person it's addressed to.
20	"We're not selling the firm."	Protect confidentiality. Never discuss selling with staff.	Like a family deciding to sell their house. They don't tell the helpers first. The owner's plans may be private, even from their own team.

E. Rules and restrictions

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
21	"We don't accept unsolicited calls. Remove us."	Exit politely and mark Do Not Call in GHL.	Like a gate with a "No Solicitors" sign. If you knock anyway, the whole village remembers your company badly. Walking away politely protects One Wealth Map's name.
22	"Calls are recorded. They can't discuss outside business on this line."	Respect the rule. Ask for an email or a better number.	Like a bank with CCTV everywhere. You don't argue with the bank's rules. You ask to talk somewhere more suitable.
23	"Our compliance team has to approve this."	Learn their process. Ask where to send information.	Like getting a building permit. You don't skip the office. You go through the right window, and things move faster.
24	"We're with a large broker-dealer. They can't take these calls."	Stay respectful. Ask for another channel. Never comment on their agreements.	Like an employee under contract. You're not their lawyer, so you don't give advice about their contract. That's for the principals.

F. Phone systems and wrong contacts

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
25	Phone menu (IVR) with no clear option	Reach a real person. Try the directory first, then “new clients.” Note what worked in GHL.	Like a mall directory. You don’t walk every floor. You look up the store. “New clients” works like the main entrance: someone is always there.
26	“There’s no one here by that name.”	Ask who owns the firm now. Update GHL.	Like an old address on a package. If you don’t fix it, the next delivery goes to the wrong house again.
27	“They retired.” / “They left the firm.”	Find the new owner. Update GHL.	Like a restaurant with a new owner. A change in leadership often means change in plans. That can be an opening.
28	“They passed away.”	Offer condolences and end the call. Note it in GHL.	Like visiting a home during a wake. You show respect and leave. Selling at that moment is never okay.

G. Outside the box

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
29	The gatekeeper is chatty and friendly.	Build rapport and learn the owner’s schedule.	Like the friendly tita at the sari-sari store who tells you when the owner usually drops by. Be friendly back. They’re your best source of information.
30	The gatekeeper is rude or hangs up.	Stay professional and try another day.	Like a grumpy jeepney driver. It’s their bad day, not yours. Next time, a different driver, or a better mood.
31	“Can you hold?” (long hold)	Keep the call. Prepare while waiting.	Like waiting in line at a bank. You fill out your form while waiting, so you’re ready when your number is called. If the line is too long, ask for another time.
32	“Talk to our operations manager instead.”	Decide if that person can help you reach the owner.	Like being sent to a different office window. Be polite. They may not decide, but they may walk you to the right door.
33	The gatekeeper wants all the details.	Stay short without sounding secretive.	Like a movie trailer. You share enough to show it’s worth it, and save the full story for the owner.
34	Third callback, same gatekeeper	Use their name and mention the last call.	Like the guard at your office who now greets you by name. Polite persistence turns a stranger into an ally.
35	The owner answers unexpectedly.	Switch to owner mode right away. Use the playbook opening.	Like waiting in a lobby and the boss walks past you. Don’t freeze. Greet them and introduce yourself. Always have your opening ready.

Quick reminders

- **Use first names:** the owner's and the gatekeeper's.
- **Be short:** your reason fits in one sentence.
- **Be honest:** never pretend to know the owner or make up a reason.
- **Keep it confidential:** no deal talk, no numbers, no other firm names.
- **Always ask for one more thing:** a time, a direct line, or an email.
- **Log everything in GHL:** gatekeeper's name, best time, what worked.
- **Respect "remove us":** a polite exit is a professional win.